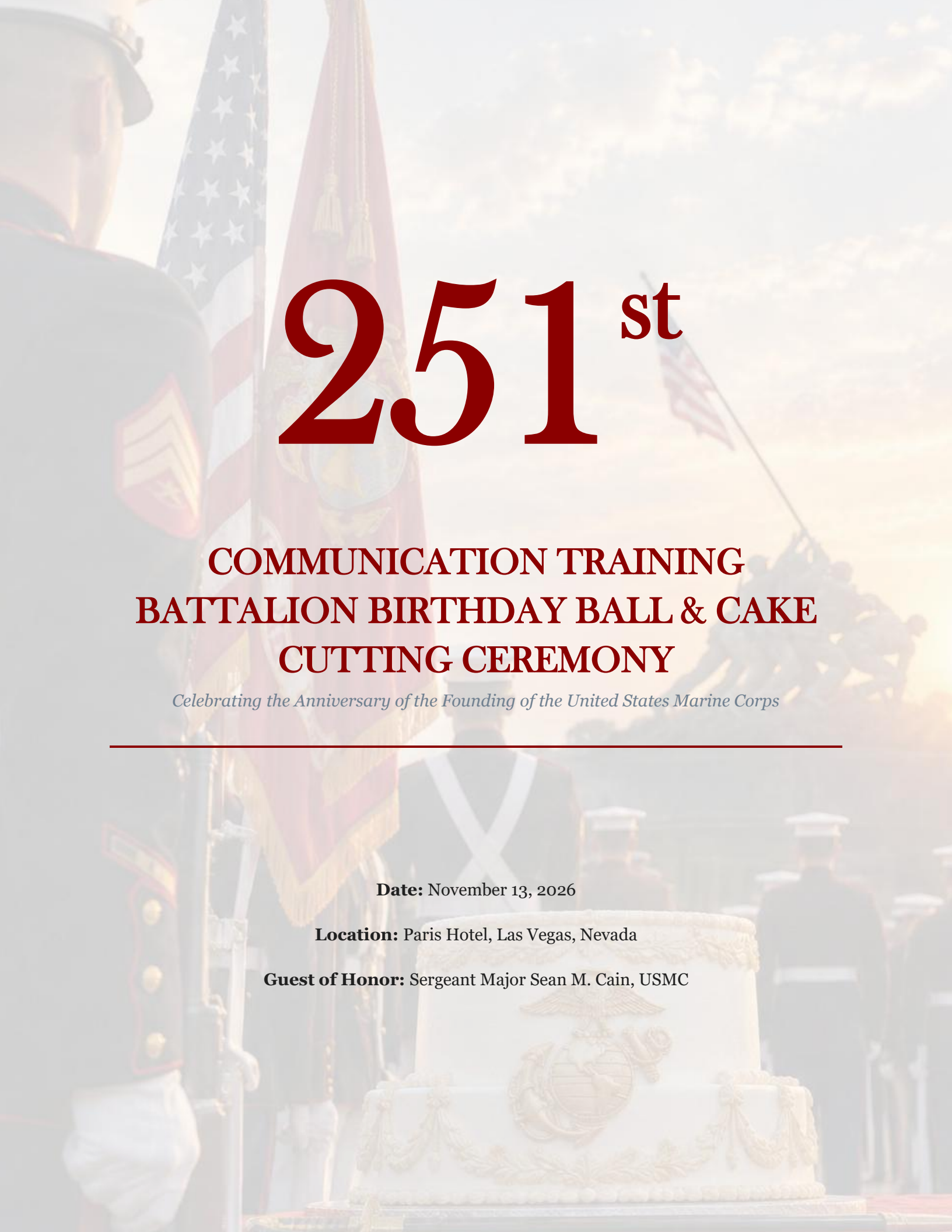


251st

COMMUNICATION TRAINING BATTALION BIRTHDAY BALL & CAKE CUTTING CEREMONY

Celebrating the Anniversary of the Founding of the United States Marine Corps

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Date: November 13, 2026

Location: Paris Hotel, Las Vegas, Nevada

Guest of Honor: Sergeant Major Sean M. Cain, USMC

1. Sequence of Events

Time	Event / Activity
Social Hour & Formal Assembly	
1700	Cocktails and Social Gathering (Champagne Foyer, Paris Hotel)
1745	Call to Quarters / Guests Be Seated
1800	Sound Adjutant's Call & March On of the Staff
The Formal Ceremony	
1805	Entry of the Official Party and Guest of Honor
1810	Presentation of the Colors & The National Anthem
1815	Invocation by the Unit Chaplain
1820	Reading of General John A. Lejeune's Birthday Message (Marine Corps Order No. 47)
1825	Presentation of the 39th Commandant of the Marine Corps Birthday Message & Video Presentation
1835	The Traditional Cake Cutting Ceremony • March on of the Traditional Birthday Cake • Presentation of the Traditional Sword • First Piece: Presented to the Guest of Honor, Sergeant Major Sean M. Cain • Second Piece: Presented to the Oldest Marine Present, Master Gunnery Sergeant Richard Zepeda, 48 years old, born February 23rd, 1978 • Passing of the Cake: The Oldest Marine passes the cake to the Youngest Marine Present, Lance Corporal Maria G. Chavez-Bardales, 19 years old, Born Febuary 17th, 2007, symbolizing the passing of experience, wisdom, and tradition to the new generation of Marines
1850	Address by the Guest of Honor: Sergeant Major Cain, USMC
1905	Retirement of the Colors
1910	Playing of the Marines' Hymn
Dinner & Reception	
1915	Formal Dinner Commences
1945	Traditional Toasts & Remarks
2030	Music, Dancing, and Evening Festivities
2330	Concluding Remarks & Final Call

2. Guest of Honor Biography



Sergeant Major Sean M. Cain, USMC

Sergeant Major Cain enlisted in the Marine Corps in July 2003 and attended Marine Corps recruit training at MCRD San Diego. Following recruit training Sergeant Major Cain attended infantry training at the School of Infantry west where he earned the Military Occupational Specialty (MOS) of 0311 Rifleman.

Upon completion, Sergeant Major Cain reported to Basic Security Guard School at Chesapeake, Virginia and received the MOS of Marine Corps Security Force Marine, 8152. Upon graduation in March 2004, Sergeant Major Cain reported to Marine Corps Security Force Battalion Kings Bay, Georgia. During which Sergeant Major Cain completed Close Quarter Combat School (CQB) and earned the MOS of 8154. While serving in CQB team 3 he was promoted to Corporal in December 2005. In March 2006, Sergeant Major Cain was transferred to 1st Battalion 5th Marines, 1st Marine Division.

From June 2006 to January 2007, Sergeant Major Cain deployed with the 31st Marine Expeditionary Unit. Following the deployment Sergeant Major Cain attended Infantry Squad Leaders Course at School of Infantry West. In June 2007 he promoted to Sergeant and deployed from November 2007 to June 2008 with the 11th Marine Expeditionary Unit. From May to December 2009, Sergeant Major Cain deployed to Nawa District, Helmand Province, Afghanistan in support of Operation Enduring Freedom. From March to October 2011, Sergeant Major Cain deployed to Sangin District, Helmand Province, Afghanistan in support of Operation Enduring Freedom. Upon return, Sergeant Major Cain was assigned to Marine Combat Instructor School 3-12.

Upon completion of Marine Combat Instructor School, Sergeant Major Cain earned the MOS 0913 and was assigned to F Company, Marine Combat Training Battalion, SOI(W) to serve as a Combat Instructor. While at SOI(W) Sergeant Major Cain was promoted to Staff Sergeant and attended Infantry Unit Leaders Course earning the MOS of 0369. He served as Platoon Commander and primary instructor within MCT Battalion instructor group. In June 2015 Sergeant Major Cain was transferred to 2d Battalion, 8th Marines, 2d Marine Division.

From July 2015 to July 2016 Sergeant Major Cain served as Weapons Platoon Sergeant, and Company Gunnery Sergeant for G Company, 2d Battalion, 8th Marines. In August 2016, Sergeant Major Cain deployed to Black Sea Rotational Force 16.2 Mihail Koglincea Romania, and served as Weapons Platoon Commander. Upon return, Sergeant Major Cain was assigned to II MEF Expeditionary Operations Training Group (EOTG) aboard Camp Lejeune, NC. Sergeant Major Cain was promoted to Gunnery Sergeant in September 2017 and served as Exercise Chief for EOTG, designing the pre-deployment training programs for the 22nd, 24th, and 26th Marine Expeditionary Units, from June 2017 to July 2020.

In July 2020 Sergeant Major Cain executed orders to 3d Battalion, 3d Marine Regiment, 3d Marine Division. Sergeant Major Cain served as Company Gunnery Sergeant for L Company and deployed as part of the Unit Deployment Program Program to Okinawa, Japan. Sergeant Major Cain was frocked to First Sergeant on 1 July 2021 and served as Company First Sergeant for Weapons Company, 3rd Battalion 3rd Marine Regiment. Sergeant Major Cain deployed from June to December 2022 as a part of 3d Bn, 3d Marines Unit Deployment Program.

In June 2023 Sergeant Major Cain reported to Detachment Delta, 4th Law Enforcement Battalion, Force Headquarters Group aboard Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson, Anchorage, Alaska and served as the Inspector-Instructor First Sergeant.

In June of 2024 he was frocked to Sergeant Major and executed orders to Communication Training Battalion, at Marine Corps Air Ground Combat Center, Twentynine Palms, California. From July 2024 to Aug 2026 Sergeant Major Cain served as the Command Senior Enlisted Leader.

In Aug 2026 Sergeant Major Cain executed orders to 2d Battalion, 7th Marine Regiment, 1st Marine Division and is currently serving as the Command Senior Enlisted Leader.

Sergeant Major Cain's personal awards include: the Purple Heart Medal, the Meritorious Service Medal, the Navy and Marine Corps Commendation Medal with "V" and one silver star in lieu of sixth award, the Navy and Marine Corps Achievement Medal with "V" and three gold stars in lieu of forth award, and the Combat Action Ribbon.

3. General John A. Lejeune's Birthday Message

Marine Corps Order No. 47 (Series 1921)

Headquarters Marine Corps, Washington, D.C., November 1, 1921

"On November 10, 1775, a Corps of Marines was created by a resolution of Continental Congress. Since that date many thousand men have borne the name 'Marine.' In memory of them it is fitting that we who are Marines should commemorate the birthday of our corps by calling to mind the glories of its long and illustrious history.

The record of our corps is one which will bear comparison with that of the most famous military organizations in the world's history. During 90 of the 146 years of its existence the Marine Corps has been in action against the Nation's foes. From the Battle of Trenton to the Argonne, Marines have won foremost honors in war, and in the long eras of tranquility at home, generation after generation of Marines have grown gray in war in both hemispheres and in every corner of the seven seas, that our country and its citizens might enjoy peace and security.

In every battle and skirmish since the birth of our corps, Marines have acquitted themselves with the greatest distinction, winning new honors on each occasion until the term 'Marine' has come to signify all that is highest in military efficiency and soldierly virtue.

This high name of distinction and soldierly repute we who are Marines today have received from those who preceded us in the corps. With it we also received from them the eternal spirit which has animated our corps from generation to generation and has been the common hallmark of the Marines in every age. So long as that spirit continues to flourish Marines will be found equal to every emergency in the future as they have been in the past, and the men of our Nation will regard us as worthy successors to the long line of illustrious men and women who have served as 'Soldiers of the Sea' since the founding of the Corps."

4. The Cake Cutting Ceremony Tradition

The cake cutting ceremony is the central focus of the Marine Corps Birthday Ball. In accordance with Marine Corps tradition, the birthday cake is cut using a traditional Marine Corps Mameluke Sword, symbolizing that Marines are a band of warriors, dedicated to the defense of our Nation.

- **The First Slice:** Awarded to the Guest of Honor as a gesture of deep respect and gratitude for their leadership, service, and presence.
- **The Second Slice:** Presented to the Oldest Marine present, honoring their long devotion, wisdom, and years of faithful service to the Corps and the Nation.
- **The Passing of the Slice:** The Oldest Marine immediately passes the piece of cake to the Youngest Marine present, signifying the vital transmission of history, battle-proven honor, and sacred traditions from the seasoned veterans to the future guardians of the Corps.

5. Evening Banquet Menu & Toasts

Evening Banquet Menu

Starter

Paris Field Greens with Champagne Vinaigrette, Shaved Heirloom Vegetables, and Candied Pecans

Entrée Choice

• Duet of Peppercorn-Crusted Filet Mignon and Herb-Roasted Breast of Chicken, Yukon Gold Mashed Potatoes, and Seasonal Asparagus
• Pan-Seared Chilean Sea Bass with Lemon Beurre Blanc
• Wild Mushroom Risotto with Truffle Oil and Roasted Garden Vegetables (Vegetarian Option)

Dessert

Traditional Marine Corps Birthday Cake and Parisian Chocolate Mousse Trio

Beverages

Coffee, Tea, and Table Wine

Formal Evening Toasts

1. To the Commander-in-Chief:
"To the President of the United States!"
Response: "Hear, Hear!"

2. To the United States Marine Corps:
"To the United States Marine Corps and all who have borne the title!"
Response: "Semper Fidelis!"

3. To the Guest of Honor:
"To our distinguished Guest of Honor, Sergeant Major Cain!"
Response: "Ooh-Rah!"

4. To Fallen Comrades:
"To those valiant Marines who gave the ultimate sacrifice in defense of our freedom."
Response: (Observed in Reverent Silence)

6. Committee & Acknowledgments

Ball Committee Chairman	Gunnery Sergeant Eric M. Given, USMC
Master of Ceremonies	Sergeant Major Edward, Roacho, USMC
Ceremonial Adjutant	Second Lieutenant Jacob T. Wilson, USMC
Color Guard Commander	Sergeant Maryland J. Smith, USMC
Ticket & Seating Coordinator	Gunnery Sergeant Eric M. Given, USMC

Special Thanks

The Staff and Management of the Paris Hotel, Las Vegas, Nevada; the United States Marine Corps Band; and the generous volunteers and sponsors whose dedication made this evening memorable.